Huzaifa Sa'ad

Backend Developer | Python | Django | REST APIs

houzsaad@gmail.com | +234 906 601 6407 | Jigawa, Nigeria

linkedin.com/in/huzaifa-sa-ad-7814a1377 | github.com/Houzsaad | houzsaad-portfolio.vercel.app

SUMMARY

Backend developer who builds and ships fintech and community products. Built a VTU (airtime and data) platform for a paying client, and Student Resource Hub, which reached 100 users within two days of its testing phase. Specialised in Django REST APIs, secure wallet and payment flows, and production deployment. Now building a second VTU platform from scratch. B.Sc. Information Technology student at Sule Lamido University, Kafin Hausa (2024–2028). Open to remote and full-time roles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3

Backend: Django, Django REST Framework, REST API design, JWT and session authentication, OTP email verification, role-based access control, Celery and Redis (basic)

Frontend: React (Vite), React Router, Context API, Bootstrap, PWA basics

Databases: PostgreSQL, SQLite, ORM query optimisation, pg_dump backup and restore

Integrations: VTPass and DodoData APIs, Monnify (in progress), Resend and Gmail SMTP (email delivery), Cloudinary (file storage)

DevOps and Tools: Git, GitHub, Postman, Swagger/OpenAPI (drf-spectacular), Render, Vercel, Gunicorn, WhiteNoise

Practices: OOP, design patterns (Observer, Factory, Strategy, Repository, Decorator), idempotent APIs, unit testing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE AND PROJECTS

SMD (Salisu Mahadi Data) – VTU Reseller Platform

Freelance · Paying client

Backend Developer

Live link | GitHub

- **Problem.** A reseller client needed a platform to sell airtime and data on MTN, Airtel, Glo and 9mobile, with customer money handled safely.
- **Built.** End to end, from requirements to deployment: a wallet with deposits, withdrawals and cashback, a bcrypt-hashed transaction PIN, OTP email verification, and UUID-referenced transaction history. Integrated VTPass during development and switched to the DodoData API for production.
- **Challenge.** Vendor API calls fail and get retried. Handled with idempotent requests and automatic refunds on VTPass failure codes 012, 014 and 016, so a failed purchase returns the customer's money.
- **Trade-off.** Chose a server-rendered, session-based two-step purchase flow with no JavaScript frontend over a React app: less interactive, but simpler to secure and faster to deliver.
- **Delivery.** Deployed on Render with PostgreSQL, Gunicorn and WhiteNoise, with PWA support. It served real users while active and is no longer in service.

  Stack: Python, Django, PostgreSQL, VTPass API (development), DodoData API (production), Gmail SMTP, Bootstrap, Render

Student Resource Hub (SRH)

Personal project · 2025 – 2026

Backend and Frontend Developer

Live link | GitHub

- **Problem.** A friend could not recover a course PDF from five months earlier. Past questions were scattered across WhatsApp groups and phones. SRH is one permanent, searchable library organised by faculty, department and level.
- **Traction.** 100 users within two days of the testing phase. Testers described the same pain unprompted; one used to screenshot past questions into Snapchat just to keep them.
- **Built.** Django REST Framework API and React (Vite) frontend: JWT auth, student, lecturer and admin roles, search, ratings, threaded comments, notifications, download tracking, and password reset by email through Resend.
- **Trade-off.** Anyone can submit, but a department moderator approves each upload (pending, approved or rejected), instead of locking uploads behind permissions students dislike. Schema changes stay additive so the live database is never restructured.

- **Challenge.** Cloudinary served PDFs as raw downloads, which broke preview. Traced the cause and rewrote the delivery URLs so PDFs open in the browser.
- **Lesson.** An unverified backup silently lost about 50 test accounts before launch. Rebuilt it as a pg_dump and restore routine, and now verify every dump's table count before trusting it.

  Stack: Python, Django, DRF, PostgreSQL, JWT, React (Vite), Cloudinary, Resend, Render, Vercel

AutoPay – School Bus Fee Automation *Team project · 1st place, hackathon 2026*

Team member

- **Idea.** Students link their bank account to the school site, and the site automatically deducts the bus fee every week for the seven days of transport.
- **Team.** Built with teammates, not alone, and won 1st place at the Sule Lamido University hackathon.

Auction Marketplace API *Technical assessment · 2026*

Backend Developer GitHub

- **Context.** Completed in under three days for a volunteer engineering role, and accepted onto the team.
- **Problem.** Auctions need strict, fair bidding. Enforced four rules: a bid must exceed the current price, owners cannot bid on their own listing, expired auctions reject bids, and the current price updates atomically.
- **Security.** JWT with token blacklisting on logout, an email-based custom user model with roles, and an object-level permission class (IsOwnerOrAdminOrReadOnly).
- **Design decision.** Lazy auction closing through close_if_expired() on the model, reused by both the API and a management command, so the logic exists once.
- **Quality.** 30+ tests across models, views and permissions, plus Swagger/OpenAPI docs with drf-spectacular.

  Stack: Python, Django, DRF, JWT, drf-spectacular

Savewizely – Locked Savings API *Personal project · In progress*

Backend Developer API docs | GitHub

- **Problem.** Everyday money apps make spending too easy. Savewizely lets users lock funds until a chosen date or savings goal, with early withdrawal allowed for a penalty fee.
- **Built.** Django REST Framework backend: custom user, wallet, transaction ledger, locked savings, savings goals and contributions, with register, login and password reset.
- **Trade-off.** Backend first, with no frontend, so the money logic is solid before any UI exists. Matured locks and completed goals return funds to the wallet automatically instead of needing a manual claim.

  Stack: Python, Django, DRF, PostgreSQL, Postman

VTU Platform, second build *Personal project · In progress*

Backend and Frontend Developer

- **Built so far.** Django REST API and React PWA, built feature by feature (API, tested, then UI): registration, JWT login, profile, change password and change transaction PIN, with Swagger docs.
- **Now building.** A deposit-only wallet funded by bank transfer and confirmed by webhook, with unique payment references, atomic crediting and row locking to prevent double-crediting.

  Stack: Python, Django, DRF, PostgreSQL, React (Vite), JWT

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Information Technology, Sule Lamido University, Kafin Hausa *2024 – 2028*

Won 1st place at the Sule Lamido University hackathon, 2026, with the AutoPay team project.